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Editorial Office

International Journal of Infectious Diseases

Dear Editor,

We submit for your consideration the manuscript entitled **"The risk was already there: infectious disease importation at the 2026 FIFA World Cup"** by Jose L. Herrera-Diestra, Nyall Jamieson, Mallory J. Harris, Kaiming Bi, Martial L. Ndeffo-Mbah, Melissa Zeynep Ertem, and Amera Al-Amery. All authors have read the current Instructions to Authors for the *International Journal of Infectious Diseases*, confirm compliance with those instructions, and accept the conditions therein. All authors have seen and agreed to the submitted version of the manuscript. All individuals acknowledged in the manuscript as contributors or providers of personal communications have agreed to their inclusion.

We confirm the following:

- The work has not been published previously.
- The manuscript is original work and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere.
- Submission is approved by all authors.

The material is original and has not been submitted for publication simultaneously elsewhere. If accepted, the paper will not be published elsewhere in the same form, in English or in any other language, without the written consent of the copyright holder.

We believe this work will be of interest to readers of the *International Journal of Infectious Diseases*, as it provides the first city-specific, uncertainty-quantified importation risk estimates for the 2026 FIFA World Cup, with an explicit diaspora seeding pathway not addressed in prior mass-gathering analyses.

Yours sincerely,

Jose Herrera-Diestra, Ph.D.

(On behalf of all authors)